COACHING MODULE



SELBORNE COLLEGE RUGBY CLUB

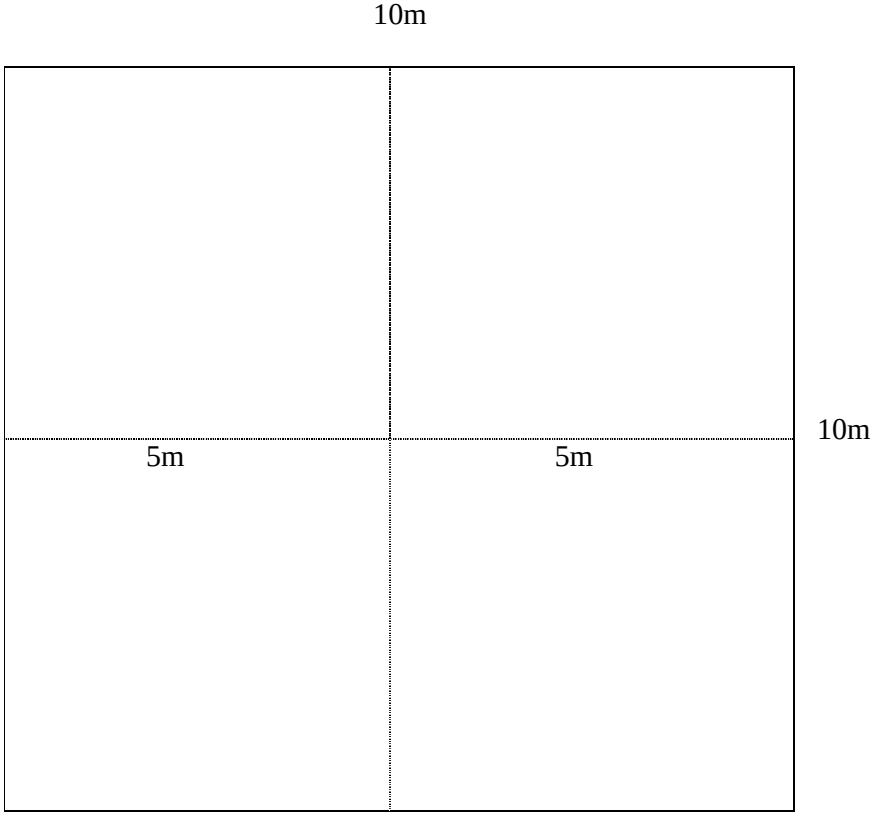
Module 4: **General Drills and Fun Games**

Compiled by: A. Miles

GENERAL DRILLS:

Get the team into three groups of five.
Everyone must be in the same grid of 10m by 10m.
They must perform different skills amongst each other in their groups at a slow jogging pace.
This is a good skill and communication drill.

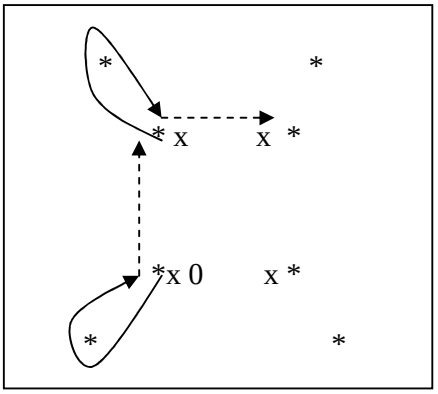
1. Normal Passing
2. Pop Passing
3. Placing on Ground
4. Hot Potato
5. Low Passing
6. High Passing
7. Left Hand (right hand behind back)
8. Right Hand (left hand behind back)
9. Dribbling



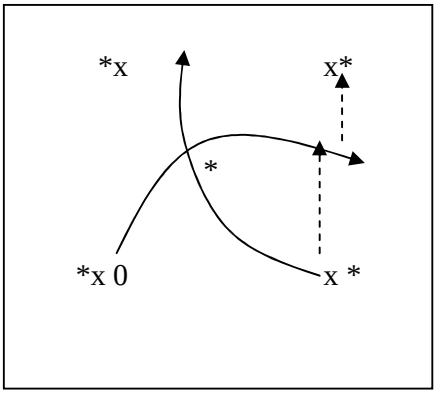
Split the team into four groups each on a corner of the larger grid:

1. Normal passing left then right

2. Ball receiver runs around the outside beaken with the ball in two hands and passes.



3. Player that passes runs around centre beaken and receives ball running through the gap. “Truck and trailer”



4. Groups opposite each other crossing in the middle and popping to each other.

5. Placing in the chest.

6. Placing the ball on the ground.

7. Rolling the ball.

You can use the smaller grids for further drills:

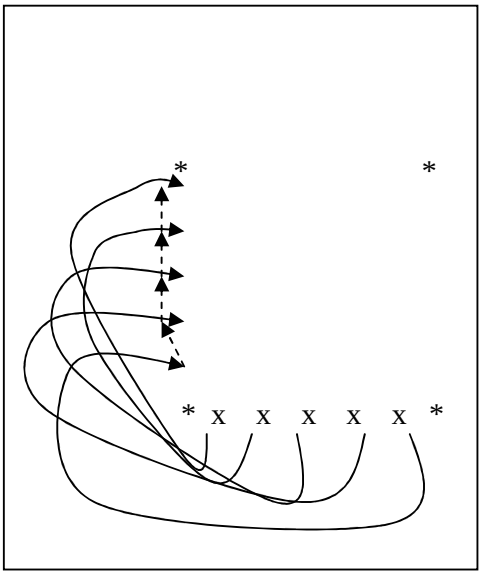
1. Split them into their groups.
   Four must be on the corners and one in the middle.
   The man in the middle must try and intercept the ball or touch the player with the ball.
   Then they swop.
   No lob passing and all mistakes will put the player at fault on.

2. The fifth player starts off at one corner.
   He passes the ball to the next corner and runs around to receive it.
   This is repeated until he gets back where he started.
   Then the next man does it

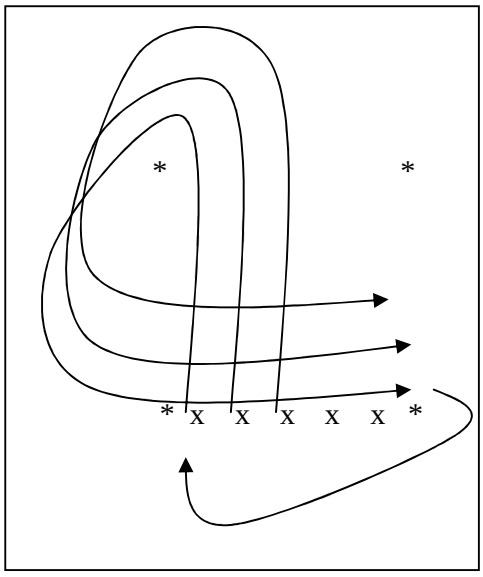
3. Stay in your groups.
   The group forms a backline and pass the ball down the line preventing to run the wing out.
   The wing must get the ball and place it by the cone.
   The scrumhalf must get there to pass it again.
   The other players must come around the cone quickly and get the ball running straight.
   Groups go one at a time.
   The other groups watch.
   It is important to watch your angels of running.

Passing and Realignment Drill:

Varaition 1:



Variation 2: Figure 8



Big Grid Drills:

Make a bigger grid 22m by 22m

1. Split the team into four groups on each corner.
   Two players are in the middle and a player from each corner goes up the field passing the ball.
   They fall out at the other end and another two join.
   The players in the middle stay until they are tied.
   This is a good drill to work on combinations, skills and fitness.

2. Split the team into four equal groups.
   Two players defend on each side of the grid.
   The group must try and score as many times in a minute without being touched with the ball or having the ball interfered with.

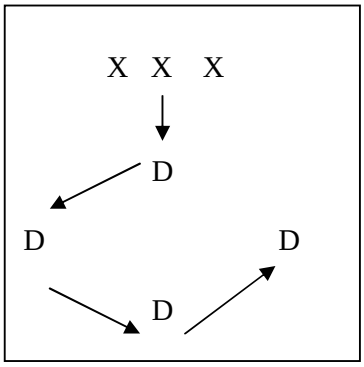
3. Four players on either side of the grid, standing opposite each other with one ball.
   The rest of the team goes through the middle one by one receiving the ball and passing it.
   They must concentrate on the three stages:
   When the ball is coming from the left.
   Hands out receiving the ball with your right foot forward.
   Bringing the ball in front of you sinking the hips.
   Passing the ball on your left foot.

4. Make groups of four.
   You have three tackling bags in the middle with a ball on one of them.
   Three players tackle and the fourth player picks the ball up.
   The tacklers must get to their feet as quickly as possible.
   They then must pass the ball down the line.
   The wing must score on the cone on the 22m.
   The rest loop around and receive the ball from the scrumhalf.
   They then leave the ball at the tackling bags and the next group goes.

Forwards / Backs Cleaning Out Drill:

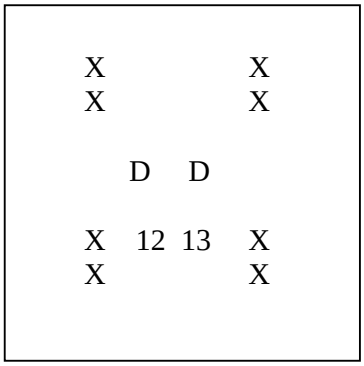
Split the pack and the backline holds tackling bags positioned up the field.
First pack takes the ball up and cleans out, while the other pack runs off 9 and takes it up again.
Then swap the forwards and the backs.
They must concentrate on low body positions when cleaning out.

Cleaning Out Drill:



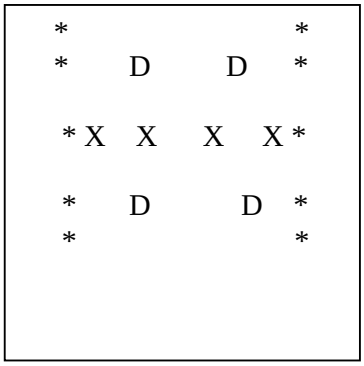
4 defenders and 3 attackers
Defenders in body armour
First attacker takes the ball up into a defender
Second attacker cleans out
Third attacker picks ball up and the above is

Passing Combinations Drill:



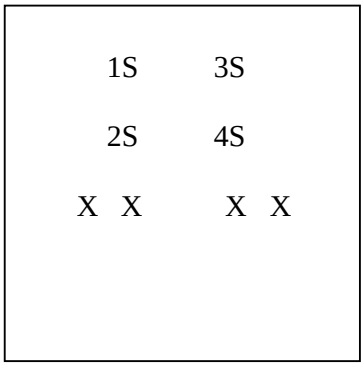
From the tryline to the 22m
Spit the team into four equal groups
Combinations are put in the middle who pass the ball down the line between four of the attackers
The players in the middle stay in the middle until replaced
One or two defenders can be introduced

Passing Drill (time pressure):



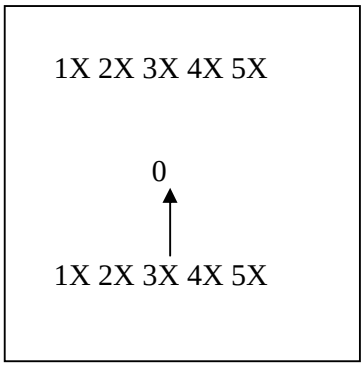
Split the team into sides of four
The attacking players try and score as many times as they can in two minutes
Defenders start off defending like touch rugby and then full on contact can be introduced

Attacking Drill (with surprise defender):



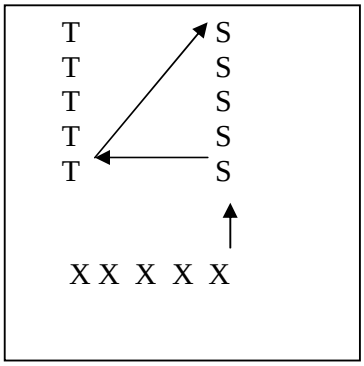
Team split into teams of four
Attackers try and get through the defenders holding shields (A channel must be demarcated)
Coach calls number of defender who can defend
This can also be built into full on contact

Defence and Attack Drill:



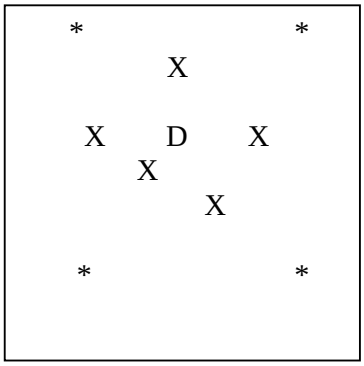
Divide the team into two pairs each with the same number
Split up on the 22m and tryline facing each other
Coach shouts number and then the pair fight each other for the ball
The ball can be left in the middle of the field or the coach can kick it into the area
More numbers can be called at once to create a defending and supporting situation

Supporting and Tackling Drill:



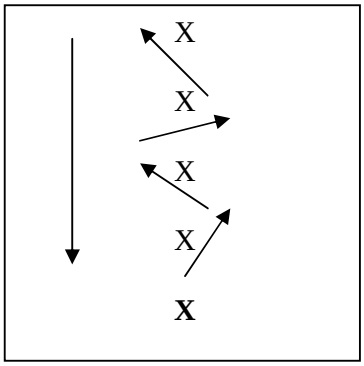
Split the team into teams of five
Two groups hold Shields and Tackle bags
The other groups of five take the ball up
First man hits the shield while the second rips and then hits the next shield
The first man then tackles the bag and once the whole process is over the group forms a backline to pass the ball down the line

Tackling and Fitness Drill:



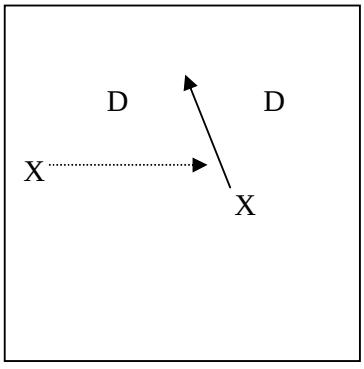
One defender with five attackers in a 10m grid
The defender is given two minutes to tackle as many times as he can
The attacking players move around the grid

Side-Stepping Drill:



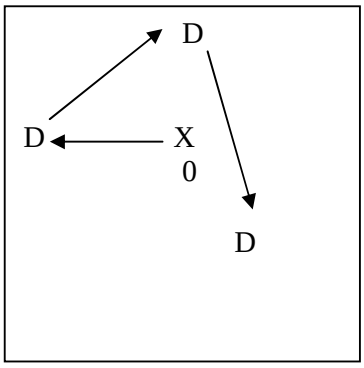
Player **X** side steps through the other players while they run towards him

Passing into Space:



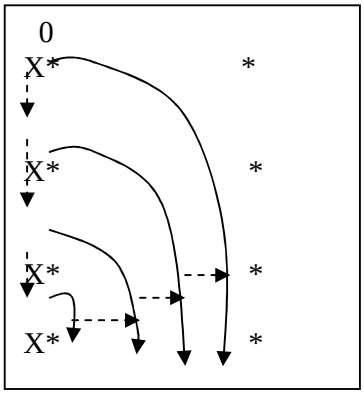
Attackers attack the defenders and must learn to pass into the space
It is important for the supporter to learn to run into the space
Defenders start off as just standing and not interfering
Gradually full on contact can be introduced

Body Positioning / Endurance:



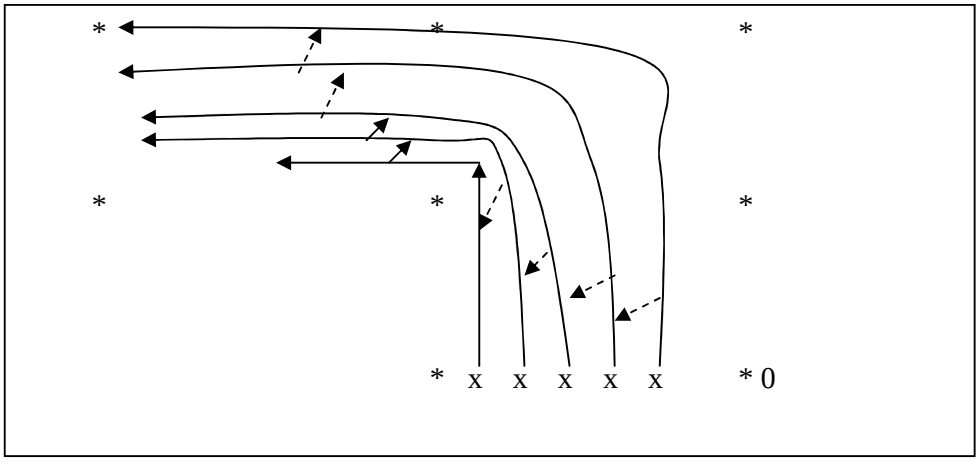
Defenders holding hit shields and attacker with ball
Attacker hits shields for two minutes without
Stopping.

Passing / Moves Drill 1:

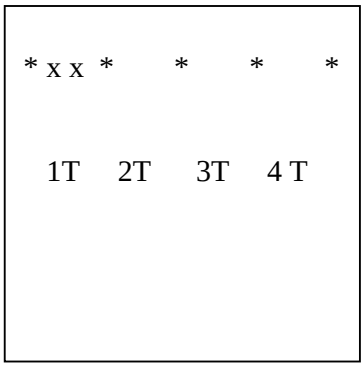


This is a good drill because moves can be introduced
Players also learn to follow their pass
A large squad can be used and defenders can also be included

Passing / Moves Drill 2:

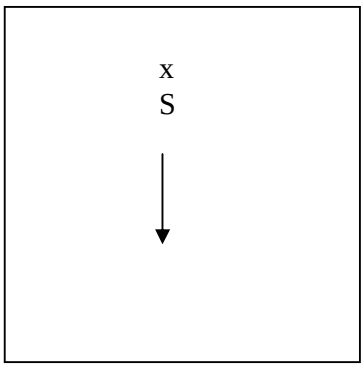


Single / Double Tackle: ‘Two man tackle’



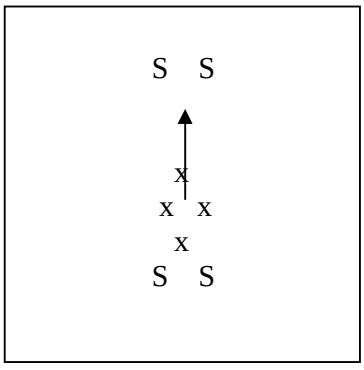
2 Players tackle together, 1 low and 1 high.
They then move on to 2T when another pair is introduced. They call it “hold, hold… PRESS!”
This can also be done with just 1 Player.
It is good to emphasize the communication.

Hit and Drive:



The player hits the shield, drives it back and lies down. They then repeat it.
Great fitness exercise.

Cleaning Out Drill:



Players take it up clean out and the last man then picks it up and runs to the next shields.

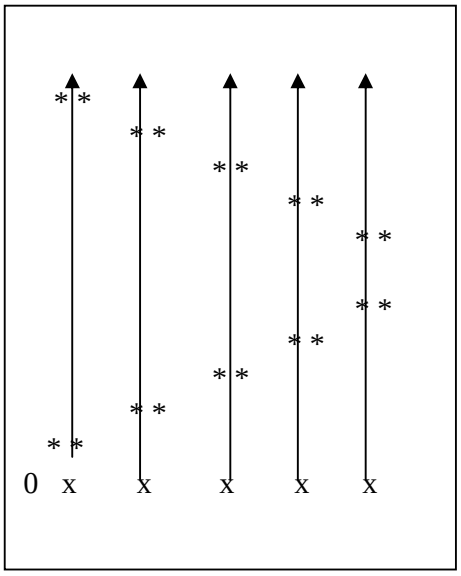
Ball Wrestle:

One player with a ball and the other player tries to rip it away from him. Do it for 1 minute. If there are not enough balls it can be 2 on 1.

Man Wrestle:

2 Players face one another on their knees with their hands on their side. On the whistle they try and pin one another on the ground.

Passing Drill:



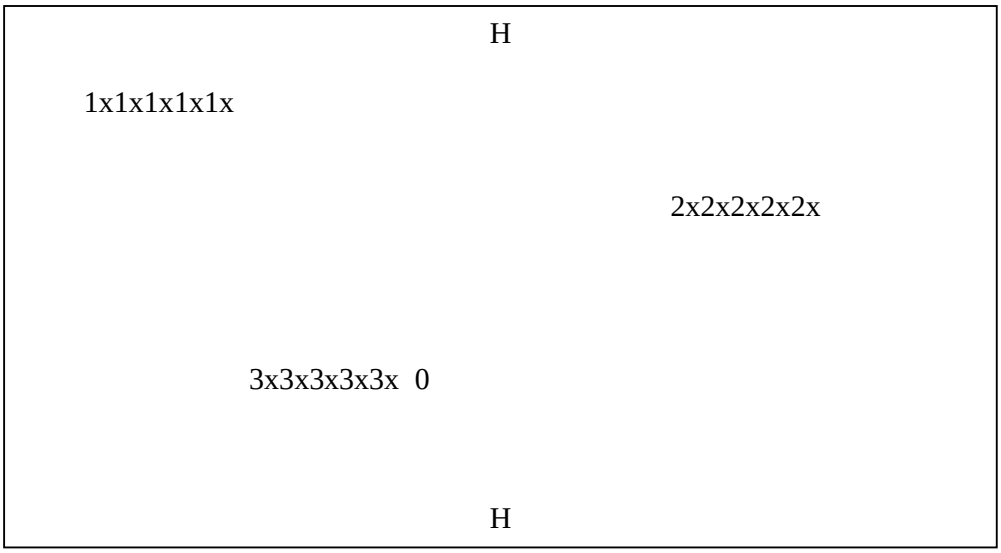
Players have to run through cones and pass.

When doing passing drills always remind the players to:

- Look up and look where they pass
- Have soft hands
- Attack the ball / run onto it
- Come from depth
- Stay in channel
- Communicate
- Hands up (target)
- Urgency

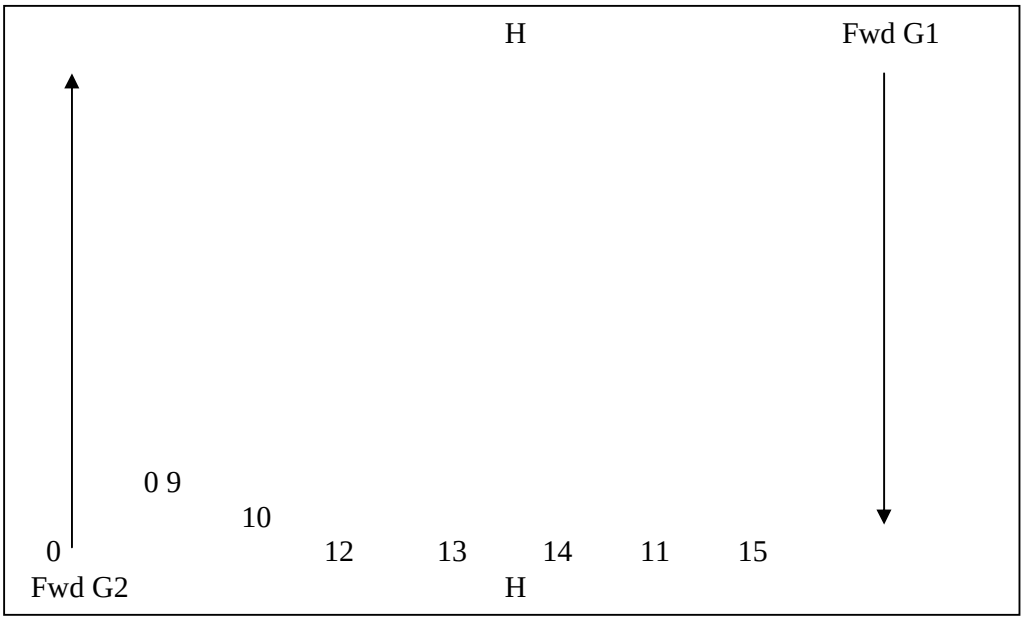
I find that it is always good to let them start a drill, make mistakes, and then stop them to remind them.

Passing / Alignment Drill:



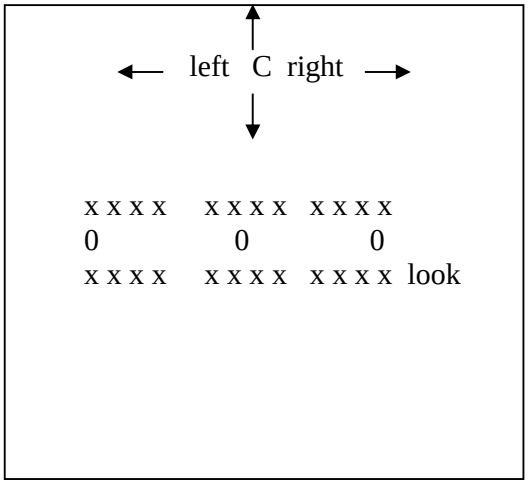
A team can be split into 3 groups. The first group swings the ball down the line and the last man puts it down. The next group takes over and so on.
Here 3x starts with the ball, 1x then pick it up and swing down their line and 2x pick up and put down, 3x, 1x etc.

Full Field Continuity Drill:



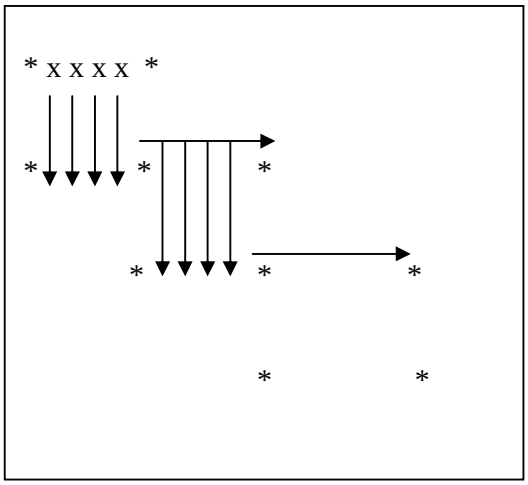
Backline runs through and do a move. They then link with a forward group, which does any of the supporting calls through to the other end. G2 and backs start together. Any variations are possible.

Defence and Alignment Drill 1:



The players opposite the coach need to look and communicate to the players opposite them which way to shuffle.

Defence and Alignment Drill 2:

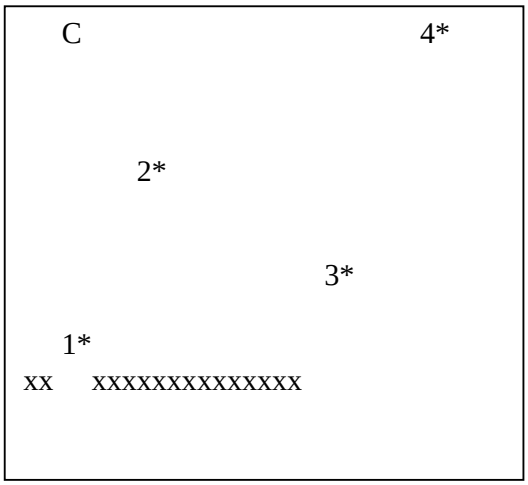


Players come up together on the call of the inside player. They then shift and go up next channel.

On defence players should be reminded to:

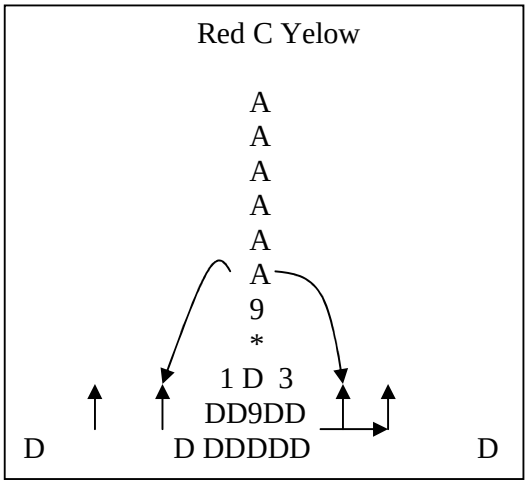
- Look up, watch the ball and the man repeatedly
- Listen for the call
- Communicate
- Stay in channel

Team Defence Drill 1:



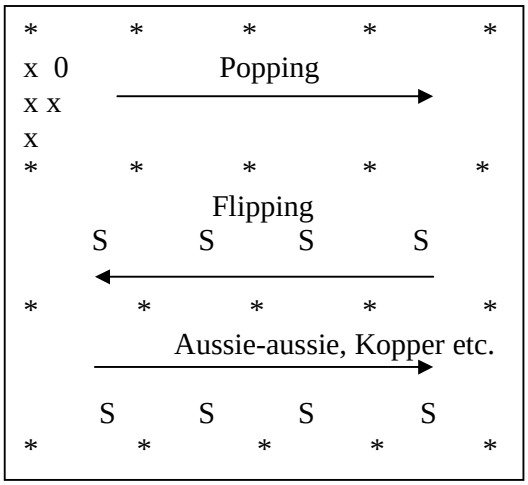
The team starts from lying down and on the coach's call and whistle they need to defend. They then defend the next ruck.

Team Defence Drill 2:



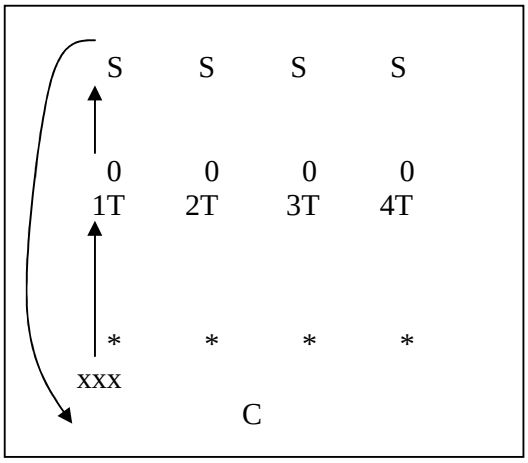
The coach shows a visual stimulus and the defenders must shout out the colour. The attacking players can go either way. The defenders must wait for the ball to be passed before they can "rush". In the normal defensive pattern the 9 will play a sweeping role. If there are not two 9's you must also let him have a go at defending.

Supporting Calls Drill:



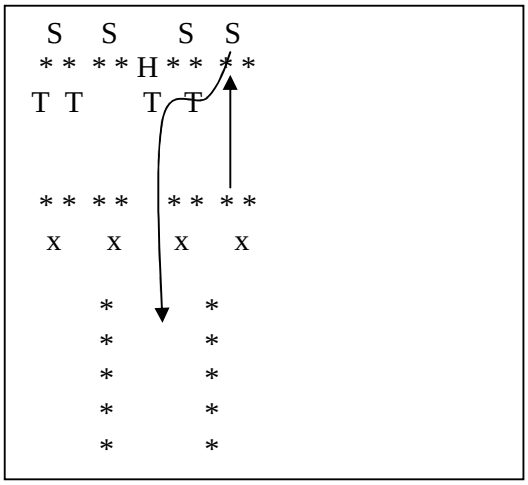
Zones are set up and the supporting calls can be used in each of the zones.

Tackle / Shield Continuity Drill:



There must be a ball on each tackle bag.
Players work in threes.
P1 tackles and P2 catches and runs into shield.
P2 then pops to P3.
The group comes back and waits for the coach's call eg. Tackle bag 1 or 2 etc.
The variations are endless.
Emphasise the need to call the supporting calls.

Cleaning out and Supporting Calls Drill:



Drill used to emphasise height of the clean out (Boing take off) and to work on picking up a man to get him out the way.
Channel then used to work on supporting calls/starter moves etc. any variation.
A piece of rope tied across flagpoles and posts can get the right if finding difficulty.
Players start with calling defensive cal. Drive the shield away, pumping their legs. They then pick up the tackle bag and run through channel.

FUN GAMES:

Kopperstamp:

A small grid with two teams
Rucking and mauling skills (Full contact)

Sogby:

Two teams
Ball is on the ground game like soccer
To make the game like touch rugby you must scoop the ball up to another player with your foot
If you are touched the ball goes to ground
You can score a try or a goal through the posts

Touch Rugby and Six Touch:

One touch is for a quicker game and six touch is for a slower more thinking game. Six touch will benefit your side more than one touch. Different supporting calls can be used as a variation e.g. Ausie-ausie touch etc.

Adapted Touch:

Forwards versus backs
Forwards have as many touches as they like provided they don't drop the ball.
Man touched turns and the ball must be ripped within three seconds or turnover.
The ripper either goes to ground or pops to next forward.
The next forward must receive the ball running onto it or turn over.
Backline must pass first three before running and the support player is only allowed to score.
They can only be touched with two hands by the forwards.
There are plenty of variations.

Seven a side:

This is a good game to teach the team to use the ball and to be creative. Great fitness exercise and it exposes player's weaknesses. Good to use it as part of your preseason build up after six touch and before full 15 man trials.

Adapted Rugby:

Split the team in half.
They must only use the supporting drills, if they make a mistake, other sides ball.
No kicking. Make them concentrate on continuity and keeping possession.
Communication is vital and the teams should be talking all the time.

Tag:

Two teams are selected and put in a grid. One team is on and they try and tag the other players with the ball. They are not allowed to run with the ball. Time them and swap. If a player runs out they are out.

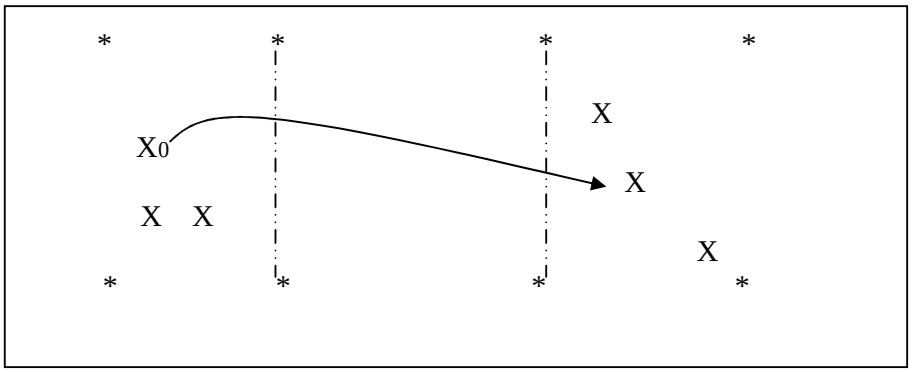
Baseball:

Players starting kick the ball from in between the poles and run. Home run if the ball goes over the halfway without bouncing. If caught they are out. There are four bases and the home base is between the poles.

Defensive Touch:

This is an extremely constructive game. It not only makes the players work but they learn how to come up together in their lines.
Sides start from their try line. The attacking side has limitless touches, but if the ball is dropped it is put down and both sides have to go back to their try line with the defending side now attacking from where the ball was left.

Kicking Tennis:



This is a great game for practicing your kicking accuracy. One team tries to kick the ball into space of the opposite team's area. They have to catch it without a bounce or it will be a point to them. The size of the grid can be increased etc. If the player catches it he needs to kick it back immediately. A variation would be to pass it to another player (supporter) to kick.

Offloading Touch:

When a player is tagged with two hands he can offload to a supporter. Limitless tags/touches when there is a mistake the opposition gets to attack. This is a great game and it will improve your teams support play.